

What's Bringing You Here

Do this one in the first day or two of the week, after your first sit. Not a full life review. Just what has charge for you right now. A few paragraphs per prompt is plenty. Keep it. You'll bring a piece of it to your Integration and Next-Step Session at the end of the four weeks.

You read the book. Something in it landed, or you wouldn't be here. This journal is a way of bringing that into focus, listening to what your body is telling you about it, and, if it surfaces on its own, tracing what might be underneath.

I told you about my turning point in the book. The body that wouldn't sleep. The gut that wouldn't quiet. The override that finally stopped working. Yours will look different. Maybe a job that no longer fits. Maybe a body that's started to fight back. Maybe a marriage that's gone quiet. Or maybe just a creeping sense that something has to give, even though you can't yet name what.

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

Take a few minutes of breath first. Don't think about the prompts yet. Sit with your eyes closed. Let your body settle. When you feel you've arrived, open your eyes and begin writing.

1. WHAT'S BRINGING YOU HERE

What is it, really?

Write about it as concretely as you can. What's the situation? What's been changing? What's the thing you keep coming back to in your head, in the shower, when you wake up at 3 a.m.? It might be a single event, or it might be a pattern that's been building for a long time and finally gotten loud enough to notice. Whatever it is, name it.

2. WHAT'S HAPPENING IN YOUR BODY

As you sit with that, what's happening in your body right now?

Don't go to ideas. Go to sensation. Where do you feel it? In your chest? Your gut? Your throat? Your jaw? Your shoulders? Notice the quality of it. Is it tight, hot, heavy, hollow, restless, numb? Don't try to fix it or make it leave. Just describe it as precisely as you can. Stay with it longer than you usually would. A minute. Two minutes. Let it be there without doing anything about it.

3. IF THAT FEELING COULD SPEAK

If the feeling in your body could talk, what might it say?

It might be about this exact moment in your life. It might be about something you've been carrying for years that this moment is finally surfacing. It might be both.

Don't filter. Don't edit. Write what comes, even if it surprises you. Even if it sounds melodramatic, or unfair, or like something you weren't supposed to admit.



4. IF SOMETHING OLDER SURFACED

If what came up in the previous prompt seems to belong to a longer history than the current situation, follow it down.

What role did you learn to play early in your life? Were you the strong one? The funny one? The competent one? The good kid? The peacekeeper? The one who didn't make trouble? The one nobody had to worry about?

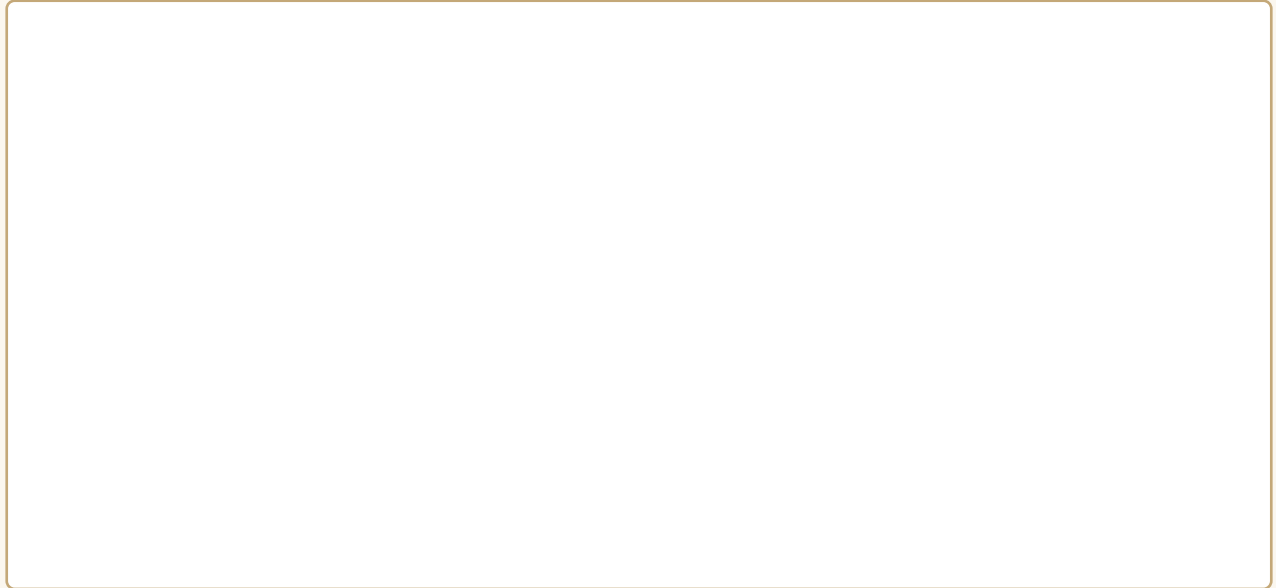
What were the unspoken terms? What did you have to be in order to stay safe, loved, or simply allowed to stay? *In exchange for connection, safety, love, or belonging in this family, I agree to ____.*

If nothing older came up, that's fine. Don't force it. Sometimes what's bringing you here is just about now.

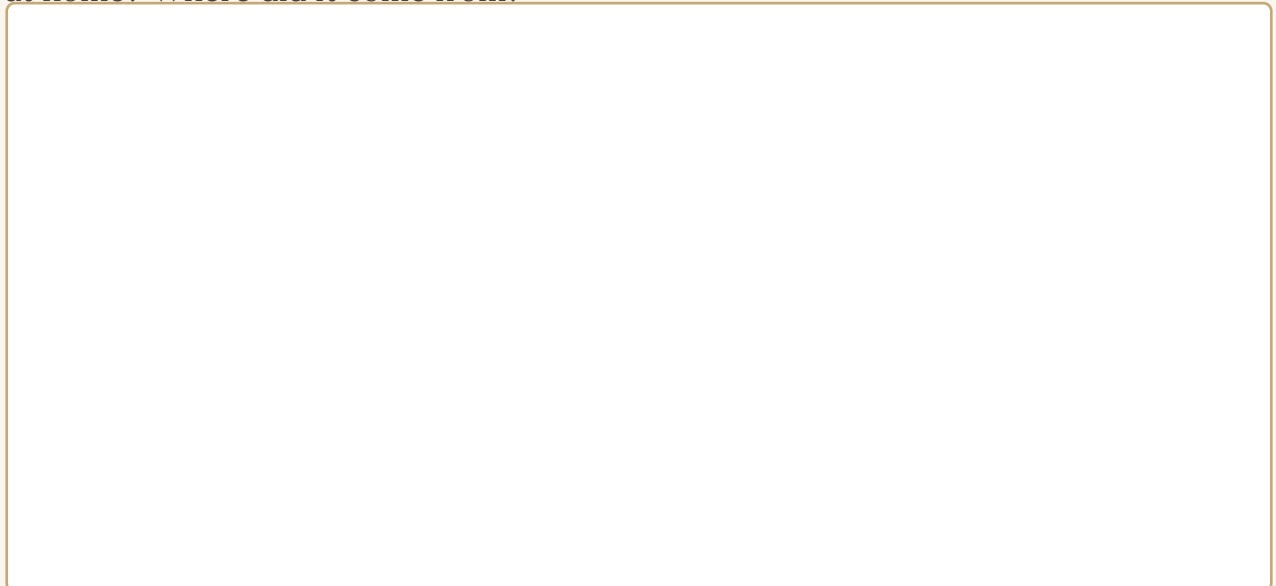
5. THE TWO YOGIS

You read the story in this week's lesson. Two yogis, one farmer, and the same answer given twice: the people in Rishikesh are very much the way you found the people in Varanasi.

If it's not a story about positive thinking, what's it about? Write your own answer. Don't look for the right one.



Then this. Your Varanasi is what you're carrying with you into your week. What is it? What's the mind you walk into the next meeting with, the next conversation, the door at home? Where did it come from?



TO CARRY INTO THE WEEK

Pick one piece of what came up. Whatever feels most alive. The thing you weren't expecting to write, the line that surprised you, the piece that's making you a little nervous to have on paper. Write it here in a sentence or two. That's what you'll be bringing to the body each day this week.